Inch -Pound

MIL-S-36957A
30 March 1989
SUPERSEDING
MIL-S-36957
23 March 1973

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

SUTURE REMOVAL KIT, DISPOSABLE, STERILE

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a sterile, disposable, suture removal kit.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specification, standards and handbooks. The following specifications, standards and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents shall be those listed in the issues of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Headquarters, Defense Personnel Support Center ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel DPSC-RST, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC/NA FSC 6515

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

PPP-B-566	-	Boxes, Folding, Paperboard-Less than 20 pounds.
PPP-B-601	-	Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	-	Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Locked-covered.
PPP-B-636	-	Box, Fiberboard
PPP-B-676	-	Boxes, Set-Up.

MILITARY

MIL-L-10547	-	Liner, Case and Sheet, Overwrap, Water Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	-	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129	-	Marking for Shipment and Storage.
MIL-STD-147	-	Palletized Unit Loads.
MIL-STD-794	-	Parts and Equipment for Packaging of.

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards and handbooks are available from the Naval Publications and Forms Center, (ATTN: NPODS), 5801 Tabor Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19120-5099).

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications, form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solictation.

DRAWINGS

Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC)

No. 24145	SUTURE REMOVAL KIT, DISPOSABLE, STERILE, 50's

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(Copies of other Government documents, drawings, and publications are available from Headquarters, Defense Personnel Support Center, ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel, DPSC-RST, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following documents form a part of this documents to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS specified in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation.

U.S. PHARMACEUTICAL CONVENTION, INC.

Pharmacopeia of the United States (U.S.P.)

(Application for copies shall be addressed to the Mack Publishing Company, Easton, PA 18042).

U.S. DEPARTMENT OF HEALTH, EDUCATION AND WELFARE

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act (FDA) and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the (Food and Drug Administration, Washington, DC 20204).

(Nongovernment standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or which distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the test of this documents and the references cited herein, the text of this documents shall take precedence. Nothing in this documents, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Metal forceps and scissors shall be stainless steel or nickel plated carbon steel. Cutting edges shall not be nickel plated. Should instruments be nickel plated, their minimum plating thickness shall be 0.0002 inch. Gauze pad shall be two-ply with a suitable filler.

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be in accordance with Federal Standard No.

3.2 Style, design, and dimensions. Shall be a sterile, disposable, suture removal kit, consisting of a gauze pad, metal forceps, and metal scissors, overwrapped in a paper towel type sheet or securely positioned in a rigid tray with a peel-open lid. Kit shall be suitable for the removal of sutures. The metal scissors shall be approximately 4-1/2 inches long, and have one scalloped and one blunt point. The metal forceps shall be approximately 4 to 4-3/4 inches long with precisely meeting tips suitable for removal of sutures. The gauze pad shall measure 4 by 4 inches. The kits component shall be in accordance with Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC) Drawing No. 24145.

3.3 Sterility. The suture removal kit shall be sterile in accordance with the USP procedures, and have a sterility assurance level of 10^{-6}.

3.3.1 Certificate of sterility. A certificate of sterility, stating that samples from each sterilizer lot have been tested and found to be sterile, shall be submitted to the procuring activity. The certificate of sterility shall include:

a. Item Identification.
b. Federal stock number.
c. Contract or purchase order number.
d. Sterility lot or control number.
e. Date of sterilization.
f. Quantity of product in sterilizer lot.
g. Type of sterilization (gas, radiation, heat, steam, etc)
h. Form of biological indicator (i.e., inoculated simulated product).
i. Test organism(s) and population desity used.
j. Test medium, incubation temperature, incubation time, and dates or tests.
k. Number of test units.
l. Statement that samples comply with sterility tests.
m. Signature of head of laboratory or a designated qualified alternate.

3.3.2 Sterility lot. A sterility lot is that single quantity of product subjected to the same manufacturing operation and simultaneously sterilized in the same sterilizer chamber. Each unit package shall be clearly marked with a sterility lot (control) number as specified in 5.3.1. Each sterility lot shall be traceable to the manufacturing lot(s).

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ercolate shall be determined ... residue before ignition. ... The color of the f

3.4 Scissors performance. On the first closing of the blades, the scissors shall be capable of cutting the following types and sizes of sutures, when tested as specified in 4.4.1; plain gut sizes down to size 0; chromic gut sizes down to size 1; braided silk sizes down to size 0 and nylon down to size 0. Each scissors tested shall cut three times. A different scissors shall be used to cut each type and size of suture specified above.

3.5 Forceps performance. Forceps shall comply with tests specified in 4.4.2.

3.6 Workmanship. Kits shall be free from defects which detract from their appearance or may impair their serviceability. The kits components shall be without rough edges, burrs, dents or any signs of corrosion.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items must meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling inspection, as part of manufacturing operations, is an acceptable practice to ascertain conformance to requirements, however, this does not authorize submission of known defective material, either inducated or actual, or does it commit the Government to accept defective material.

4.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

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4.2.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

4.3 Sampling.

4.3.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and Table I.

TABLE I. Sampling for examination.

Type defect	Unit of product	Inspection level	AQL (defects per hundred units)
Major A	Kit	I	1.0
Major B	Component	I	1.0
Minor	Component	I	2.5

4.3.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as indicated in Table II.

Table II. Sampling for tests.

Unit of Product	Characteristic	Reqmt	Test Procedure	Inspection level	AQL (Percent def)
Kit	Sterility	3.3	-	**	*
Scissors	Performance	3.4	4.5.1	S-4	2.5
Forceps	Performance	3.5	4.5.2	S-4	2.5

* Acceptance number shall be zero for all sample sizes.
** Sampling for sterility testing shall be as specified in the U.S.P. for non-parenteral devices.

4.3.3 Sample unit usage. Where feasible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

4.4 Examination. The kits shall be examined to determine compliance with all requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and the following classification of defects. Examination shall include, but shall not be limited to, the classified possible defects listed in Table III.

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TABLE III. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defect
Critical	None defined.
Major A	
101	Kit incomplete; one or more components missing.
Major B	
151	Metal parts not smoothly finished; not free of rough edges, slivers, nicks, pits, blisters, scratches, cracks, roughness, or corrosion, as applicable.
152	Style and design of components not as specified.
153	Tips of scissors or forceps bent.
154	Inside jaw of forceps not serrated.
Minor	
201	Surface debris on any component.
202	Action of closing and opening scissors not smooth and uninterrupted.
203	Cutting edge of blunt-tipped blade extends beyond the back of the opposing blade - when scissors are in closed position.

4.5 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.5.1 Scissors performance test. The strand of suture to be cut with scissors shall be held at one end, with thumb and forefinger, in vertical position. Tension shall be applied to suture by securing 25.0 gram weight to other end. Scissors shall be perpendicular to suture when in cutting position. If blade of scissors has scallop, suture to be cut shall be placed on blade approximately 1/8 inch from point of blade. The scissors and the tip of the scissors shall remain aligned after cuts.

4.5.2 Forceps performance test. The strand of suture, shall be held in the forceps and shall be capable of lifting a 4 ounce weight and holding for 10 seconds. Suture shall be held in jaws without intertwining between jaws.

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4.6 Inspection of packaging. The sampling and inspection of the packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation. Preservation shall be level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A.

5.1.1.1 Individual package. The scissors, forceps, and gauze pad shall be wrapped in a paper towel type sheet and packaged in a sealed, peel open type container, or a rigid plastic tray having a tyvek closure, of appropriate size. The container shall be capable of maintaining sterility of contents unless damaged or opened. The container shall be designed with tabs to faciliate opening and dispensing of contents. As an alternate, the components shall be packaged in a sealed plastic procedural tray. An overwrap is not required for this type of packaging.

5.1.1.2 Unit package. Fifty individually packaged suture removal kits shall be packaged in a snug fitting box conforming to PPP-B-566, PPP-B-636, class domestic, or PPP-B-676. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.1.1.3 Level C. The level C preservation for suture removal kits shall conform to MIL-STD-794 requirements for this level.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Four unit packages (200 suture removal kits) shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-601, overseas type, PPP-B-621, class 2, or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the applicable box specification.

5.2.1.1 Case liner. Each level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and sealing shall be as specified in the liner specification. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes. Each fiberboard box shall be waterproofed as specified in PPP-B-636.

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5.2.2 Level B. Four unit packages (200 suture removal kits) shall be packed in an exterior container designed for a type 2 load and conforming to PPP-B-601, domestic type, PPP-B-621, class 1, or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The level C requirements for suture removal kits shall be packed in accordance with the requirements of MIL-STD-794 for level C.

5.2.4 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units to be shipped is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units shall be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which will insure safe delivery to destination.

5.2.5 Unitized loads. Unitized loads, commensurate with the level of packing specified in the contract or order, shall be used whenever total quantities for shipment to one destination exceed 250 pounds or 20 cubic feet. Loads shall be unitized on pallets conforming to MIL-STD-147. Pallet loads including the pallet shall not exceed 54 inches in height, 43 inches in length and 52 inches in width. Quantity for shipment to one destination of less than 250 pounds or 20 cubic feet need not be palletized.

5.2.5.1 Levels A and B. Suture removal kits packed as specified in 5.2.1 and 5.2.2 shall be unitized on pallets as specified in 5.2.5.

5.2.5.2 Level C. Suture removal kits packed as specified in 5.2.3 shall be unitized as specified in MIL-STD-794.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Levels A, B, and C.

5.3.1.1 Individual package. Each individual package shall be marked in accordance with commercial practice and in addition, the marking shall include the lot number and legends: "STERILE" and "STERILITY GUARANTEED UNLESS PACKAGE IS DAMAGED OR OPENED".

5.3.1.2 Unit package, exterior container and unitized load. Each unit package, exterior container and unitized load shall be marked as specified in MIL-STD-129. Marking shall also include the lot number.

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5.4 General.

5.4.1 Exterior container. Exterior container (see 5.2.1, 5.2.2, and 5.2.3) shall be of minimum tare and cube consistent with the protection required and shall contain equal quantities of identical stock numbered items to the greatest extent practicable.

5.4.2 Packaging inspection. The inspection of these packaging requirements shall be in accordance with 4.6.

6. NOTES
(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not manditory.)

6.1 Intended use. The suture removal kit is intended for removing sutures after surgery.

6.2. Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of specification.
(b) Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.1.2).
(c) Levels of packaging and poacking (see 5.1 and 5.2)
(d) Applicable National Stock Number.

6.3 National Stock Number coverage. This specification covers the following National Stock Number:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-00-436-1881	SUTURE REMOVAL KIT, Disposable, Sterile, 50s

6.4 Subject term (key word) listing.

Disposable kit
Eliminator
Erudicator
Extractor
Extrication, suture
Kit
Suture disposal

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MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6515-4408

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-S-36957A	SUTURE REMOVAL KIT, DISPOSABLE, SHILEY

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*:

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

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